

Going Back to Elementary Years: The Parents Lived Experiences in Modular Distance Learning

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Abstract

As school shuts down, modular instruction opens new horizons in delivering quality education among all learners. The parents' involvement in modular distance learning created a difficult schedule at home, specifically that they accepted the responsibility for their children's educational development as the delivery of instructions shifted. This study explored and explicated the lived experiences of parents in the implementation of modular learning. The study employed a qualitative approach that utilizes Heideggerian Phenomenology and Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis (IPA) anchored on the Modified Van Kaam Approach popularized by Moustakas. The participants in this study were chosen using a purposive strategy in reference to the inclusion criteria set in this study. The researchers conducted interviews with ten parent participants from Balabagon Elementary School. Consequently, the following themes arise (1) The Capable, (2) The Naturalist, (3) The Realist, (4) The Level of Experience, and (5) The Light. These themes highlighted the experiences and obstacles of parents in modular learning. It is recommended that opportunities for improving parent quality and development in facilitating the children's learning should be provided and that schools should at least implement a day for Parent Seminars and Training on the topics presented in weekly modules.

Keywords: Parents, Phenomenology, IPA, Lived Experiences, Modular Instruction

Introduction

The emergence of the COVID-19 pandemic drastically changed the educational system as Modular Distance Learning was implemented. Parents' involvement in education has always been pivotal and in high demand in the learning linkages of their children. As the pandemic transpired, the Philippine educational system adapts to the new learning modality. Thus, it highlighted and further strengthen the massive parental involvement in modular learning. There are myriad of studies promoting parents' effectiveness and recommended support in giving merits to parents for their significant role in their children's academic success. However, this doesn't seem effective enough and feasible as parents are not promptly accommodated and their acknowledging parents' efforts seem useless. Further, this pandemic might be the best time to take serious action and fully support the parents. Parents' engagement in accomplishing the modular task proved that it can strengthen the positive correlation between student engagement and their cognitive abilities (Kazeem, 2018). The researchers aim to commend the parents for their great efforts and silent obstacles as they were and still are considered unsung heroes of this learning modality which should be not. In these trying times, it is imperative to acknowledge their mere existence and hard work as

they were the foundation of their home and now the foundation of their children's learning in this modular set-up. Hence, this prompts the researchers to conduct this study in exploring the lived experiences of parents regarding modular distance learning during the COVID-19 outbreak.

The phenomenon changed the classroom environment and lead to a major adjustment to the role of the parents (Bayucca, 2021). As stated by Paco et al. (2021), parents found it not easy and challenging for them to carry out their duties and obligations while assessing their children at home. Parents can't just play their significant role as parents but as educators. Being passed down the duties and responsibilities that mainly belong to teachers have greatly affected their decisions on what to give more time between household chores and educating their children. This kind of learning setup creates conflict in parents' time management on their house chores. The major shift in the teaching-learning process brought parents to experience various challenges in terms of delivering instructions, academic outcomes, financial difficulties, personal issues, pressure, and learning methodologies (Agaton & Cueto, 2021). Hence, with the sudden changes in the modular learning modality of teaching brought by Covid-19 what do parents have felt about these changes? What challenges and concerns do they encounter?

In light of the challenges, no one doubts that parental involvement in terms of responding to the modular activities had a tremendous effect on the learners. The practice of parents responding to their children's modules is an outgrowth of issues that parents confront, and it leads to: a) their children's low reading and writing skills; b.) the child will have little or no learning; c.) parents recalling the learning but not the child. If this practice continues, children will be less likely to learn and comprehend the topics in the modules. A majority of parents believe that modular learning is far more different from traditional classes. Going back to the original classroom set-up, they believed that their children could learn more because, for them, the teacher moderates and regulates the flow of knowledge since they have educational training. Despite the challenges presented by the new setup in learning, parents never fade to assess their children's learning. They cope with the challenges with determination because they want to provide their children with a quality education.

Parents work in consortium with teachers considering the fact that education can no longer happen within school walls. As stated by the Department of Education (DepEd) with regards to modular distance learning, parents need to fill several duties at home to educate their children. Therefore, they are given a big responsibility to fulfill (Llames, 2021). However, difficulties are unavoidable in spite of the attempts to help parents in this challenging chore of facilitating children at home (Garbe et al, 2020). This current educational situation presented hurdles not only to teachers but as well as to parents. Though recent studies of Parczewska (2020), Cahapay (2020) and Garbe et al. (2020), it aimed to determine how do parents take on the role of educating their children, they made no attempt to investigate the parents' lived experiences (Cahapay, 2021). Thus, this can be proven as a pivotal research gap.

This study delves into deep understanding of what parents feel and experience in this new distance learning education. The researchers want to figure out how parents give essence to their contributions even when complicated situations arise. The outcome of this study can provide a basis for teachers and school institutions in thinking of various approaches and management plans that will aid parents to give better education to their children despite the pandemic.

Research Questions

This study aims to explore the lived experiences of the parents in elementary education under modular

distance learning. Specifically, the study delves into the following questions:

1. What are the parents' struggles and challenges in the modular learning modality?
2. What are the learning opportunities of these parents in this new modality?
3. What are the positive and negative impacts of modular instruction in the parent's perspective?
4. What is the meaning of their experience?
5. What recommendations can be made based from the findings of the study?

Literature Review

The researchers have gathered an overview of the literature that provides the basis and framework of the study. According to Bayucca (2021), the influence of the COVID-19 pandemic altered the direction of providing quality education to students. According to Chang & Yano (2020), the lockdowns have placed an unprecedented burden on the government to ensure learning continuity. To continue delivering quality and relevant education amid the pandemic, the Philippines implemented a printed modular distance learning modality was implemented to continue delivering quality and relevant education amid the pandemic (Talimodao et al., 2021). This modular learning setup is far different from the traditional classroom setup learning occurs at home. Its emergence behaviorally disrupted the lives of parents as the delivery of instructions shifted to modular learning. Puspita (2021) pointed out how crucial parents are, particularly mothers, in educating their children. Parent serves as direct guidance on their children's reading, writing, and with their home tasks.

Several factors made parental involvement more difficult during these stressful times, (Soriano et al. 2022). Due to lack of vocabulary, mastery of the teachings, and English communication, comprehension abilities, and poverty hampered parents' ability to intellectually assist their children, leading them to use a variety of dispensed parenting techniques such as using Google Translate to translate unfamiliar words, searching the Internet for needed information, consulting a dictionary to resolve vocabulary issues, and enlisting the help of more knowledgeable relatives (Budao, 2021). As stated by Paco et.al (2021), parents found it not easy and challenging for them to carry out their duties and obligations to assist children at home. Parents can't just play their significant role as parents but as educators. Being passed down the duties and responsibilities that mainly belong to teachers have

greatly affected their decisions on what to give more time between household chores and educating their children. Another study by Constantino et al. (2020), stated that parents, amidst the online distance learning, parents disliked how modules were poorly printed. These are issues such as seeing unsuitable colors for models and having pieces that are difficult to read. Luaña (2021) listed how parents help their children answer modules by explaining, providing examples, correcting their children's incorrect answers, 'Googling' the answer, and directly providing the correct answers. Luaña listed three methods for parents to help their children answer modules: explaining, giving examples, and correcting their children's inaccurate answers; guiding by 'Googling' the solution; and leading by immediately delivering the proper answers. As Luaña points out, some of the featured themes were difficult for pupils to grasp due to complicated vocabulary and concepts. To combat this, parents do their utmost to explain complex subjects to their children in simple words. Parents feel that by explaining difficult words to their children, they would help them understand the gist of the teachings, which will help them answer the problems in their modules.

Further, Olivo (2021), it is a big disadvantage when parents have inadequate knowledge of certain topics. That would enable them to assist their children properly. Likewise, the same thing goes when it comes to time for other priorities at home, which is not enough, to answer the myriad of activities. Amora (2022) shows support by demonstrating that most parents are facing different challenges such as being unable to remember preceding knowledge, being drained by the circumstance, financial status, and intermittent connections. Bayod et al. (2021) elaborated on the difficulty of a mother in teaching their children since she doesn't know the answers to the questions because she hasn't even reached high school for which the level of the lesson is about and that it's better to have a personal session with the teacher so that clear explanations about the lessons will be given. Another study by Bhamani et al. (2020), explained that 1 to 1.5 hours per day to study at home using worksheets, workbooks, videos, and reading apps, but the school sessions are difficult to manage because we have a grandmother who looks after the kids at home and is not very tech-savvy." According to Garbe et al. (2020), parents are finding it difficult to strike a balance between their obligations, learner motivation, accessibility, and learning outcomes. In addition, a similar study by Kintanar et al. (2021) seeking to gain an understanding of the parents' difficulties when it comes to facing the administrated Modular Distance Learning, stated that some parents

are not knowledgeable enough when it comes to facilitating their children.

Gecolea and Gecolea (2021), revealed that parents give their best in supporting and assisting their children by sharing inputs and perspectives and provision towards the students' needs. The experiences of the unsung heroes of modular learning are the parents on their role in delivering the learning, their exploration of ways and strategies to attain the attention of the students, as a support channel and good provider assistant in imposing learning at home. Palma et al. (2021) even though parents have shortcomings parents know their integral role in their children's learning and can it can affect academic performance

The various information being discussed renders a deep understanding of the personal experiences of parents in the implementation of modular distance learning. This provides an understanding to see through a different lens the circumstances, the personal struggles, and how they cope just to give their best for their children to learn despite the situation. Modular distance learning had varied outcomes for student learning. The articles being gathered, substantiate a strong foundation of the current study being conducted.

Theoretical Underpinning

This study is anchored on Albert Bandura's Self-Efficacy Theory, a prominent subset of Bandura's (1986) social cognitive theory. A person's particular set of beliefs, according to this theory, pre-determines how an individual sees the strength and capabilities one possesses to attain a certain task (Bandura, 1977). These beliefs are harnessed by 4 main sources of influence; starting with the mastery experiences wherein it dwells on the gained experiences after one takes a task and a new challenge successfully. Second, vicarious experiences involve observing people who had mostly succeeded in their task. Third, social persuasion such as receiving positive verbal feedback motivates a person that one is capable and will succeed in doing a complex task. Finally, the highest influence is on how the effects of emotional, physical, and physiological well-being can influence a person's level of capability. Bandura firmly believed the ability to attain a goal or complete a task is determined by whether we believe we can do it (self-efficacy) and whether we believe the outcome will be satisfactory (outcome expectancy).

Parents' self-efficacy can influence the educational

outcomes of their children (Basler & Brissie, 1987). It is highly commended to have a positive sense of their abilities amidst the challenges as a positive mindset produces a positive result. The study by Hoover-Dempsey and Sandler (1995) which was based on Bandura's Self-Efficacy theory further added that a positive sense of perceived self-efficacy can possibly help parents proceed in the hub of challenges. A strong sense of self-efficacy can help a parent find ways to work with their children beyond the involvement opportunities provided by the school. Research suggests that when a parent has a positive sense of self-efficacy, the child may also develop a positive sense of self-efficacy.

Thus, it shows that during this modular learning, having a strong sense of self-efficacy is required for every parent to attain the responsibility they have in their hands. In line with this, the 4 mentioned influences of Self-Efficacy Theory inter-relates to the lived experiences of parents in elementary education as it took a turmoil in holistic capacities of parents in Modular Distance Learning.

Methodology

This qualitative study utilized the Heideggerian Phenomenology. This study aims to explicate and explore the participants' lived experiences during modular learning. Further, it identifies the meaning of the existence of their experience.

Participants

This study utilized a purposive sampling technique wherein participants were chosen to further elaborate on their lived experiences during modular learning. In addition, an inclusion criterion was crafted to identify the limitation of this study.

Inclusion Criteria

1. Participants should be a parent of the pupils in Balabagon Elementary School.
2. The participants admitted that they are the ones who answered the modules of their children.
3. There's no specific grade level.

Data Collection

A transmittal letter was created and sent to the participants to gain their approval to conduct an interview. After gaining the participants' approval, they are set for an interview as a type of house-to-

house interview. They will be recorded with the permission of the participants. A semi-structured interview guide (Smith, 2019) as the instrument was made by the researchers which were approved and validated by the experts (Cabello & Bonotan, 2020). In gathering the data, the ethical consideration set in this study was strictly followed (Bryman & Bell, 2007).

Research Rigor

The researchers utilized Whittemore et al.'s (2001) quality criteria to sustain the study's rigor. Further, this quality criteria delved more into Credibility and Authenticity; and (b) Criticality and Integrity. In addition, the rigor of this study was strengthened when the researchers performed bracketing (Cabello, 2022). Bracketing is essential in employing impartiality and avoiding biases in the conduct of the study (Alase, 2017). All the possible answers of the participants were already anticipated (Cabello et al., 2022).

Data Analysis

This study utilized the Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis (IPA) anchored on the Modified Van Kaam Approach popularized by Moustakas. The seven key steps are Horizontalizing, Reduction of Experiences to the invariant constituents, Thematic Clustering to create core themes, Comparison of Multiple Data Sources to validate the invariant constituents, Crafting of Individual Textural Descriptions, Construction of Composite Structural Descriptions, and Synthesis of the texture and structure into an expression. (Please see Table 1. *The Analysis* [Appendix 1])

Results and Discussion

After the analysis of the data gathered, the researcher conducted five important themes: Theme 1: The Capable, Theme 2: The Naturalist, Theme 3: The Realist, Theme 4: The Level of Experience, and Theme 5: The Light. These five themes showcased the lived experiences of parents in Modular Distance Learning.

The Capable

A better learning environment, adequate resources, and qualified teachers are commonly affiliated with providing learners a proper and quality education (Kenayathulla et al., 2019) however, as the paradigm shift in education turned into Modular Learning, parents' involvement becomes an integral part of

children's learning and plays a vital role in child's developmental needs. As the study by Pourrajab et al. (2018) indicates that the parent's involvement is a huge factor in children's continuous improvement. This brings a greater challenge for every parent to give their support in terms of their child's educational needs. However, not all parents are capable to teach especially when the learnings they had are being forgotten in time.

As Participant 1 said:

"Makaya ra nako siyang tudloan kung pananglit lisuran siya-kaya nako siyang suportaang ug dili na gyud niya makaya. Lisuda gyud itudlo ilabi na kay ang qkong mga nahibal-an sauna nangapapas n a." (I can only teach him if my child was having difficulties with this and I'll do what I can for my child. It's really hard to teach especially since my knowledge already faded.)

Parents are indeed the expert on their children. They can teach the basics but there are times that they seek assistance since they sometimes find the lesson confusing and that is why they prefer the classroom setup because they think their child can learn better with teachers' assistance than them especially when the child is in higher grade, the lessons become difficult.

Participant 6 stated that,

"Dili, Kay ang module karon gud kay lahi na, lisod kanang nakaskwela ko pero ang mga topic karon bisan sa grade 3 kay ni level up na. lisod siya hubaron." (No because the lessons are very difficult and different from what I have encountered way back in our time.)

As the curriculum changes, the content also changes and the demand for knowledge also changed. That is why the lessons that parents encountered in their time are way different from today's lessons. This makes it even more difficult for them to teach their child. However, despite the difficulties they had encountered, we can see that parents are doing the best they can to aid their child's learning and support them as much as possible.

Participant 8 also said that,

"Puydi raguud ug mahimo unya ug malisud najud akong anak mao ng mutabang najud ko niya pero ug sayun sayun ra siya ra kay maanad unya." (I can if possible but if my child finds it difficult, I would help. If the lesson is easy, I would let my child answer alone so that they will become independent.)

Whenever the children face difficulties, they are at their side willingly to uplift, guide, and teach them. Moreover, they let their children learn independently as well.

Participant 9 mentioned that,

"Oh, kaya nalang jd, kayahon nlang bsan kai mao may kuan kung naa palang laing choice." (Yes, I have to since I don't have any choice left but to try.)

Parents' involvement in a child's learning is needed to build strong connections and let them feel a sense of assurance. Parents are compelled to teach their children because they have no other option. Having no choice is one of the parents' responsibilities, as well as a challenge that they must face. They must at least try.

The Capable theme highlighted that as the educational system drastically changes, parents' knowledge and abilities play a major part in children's lives in the learning process because they will serve as a facilitator and a teacher. As parents cited mentioned above, most of them can teach their children but it is only limited; while others do not for various factors, however, they find alternative strategies for their children to learn effectively.

The Naturalist

With the advent of the COVID-19 pandemic subsequently closing all the schools, it becomes apparent that a significant number of parents portray a full-time role in guiding their children in the new mode of learning. Understandably, parents' natural duty is to facilitate their children's learning, especially given the fact that the paradigm shift of the educational system transforms into Modular Distance Learning. There are numerous ways for parents to participate and give time to their children's education. Parental engagement and providing time allotment to their children are the natural components of children's learning. It is evident that since the pandemic started, parents take part in guiding and supporting their children as they take on modular learning.

Participant 5 remarked that,

"Ouh, makahatag jud kay ing ana man jud na." (Yes, I can give time because that's how it is.)

In these trying times, the parents' primary duty is to build a connection where they can provide direct attention to their children. They act as home facilitators, assisting and guiding the child as they

answer the modular lessons during this temporary shift to learning.

Participant 8 stated that,

"Oh, naa jud kay kuan man di man gud mahimo ug di tudluan." (Yes, because I need to teach my child to learn.)

It necessitates a significant time commitment for parents in facilitating their children's learning, especially since they have divided responsibilities where the number of children is one of the factors that hindered their time. It is tremendously difficult for parents to take on dual duties where they have to adopt the new routines for learning.

Participant 1 stated that,

"Oo makagahin pero dili gyud full time kay naa pud koy baby pud gud." (Yes, I can spend but not full time because I have a baby.)

Although parents give in their best abilities to support and engage their children in learning, there are some instances that they encounter difficulties especially when they have limited capabilities. To achieve the goals of educating the child's learning, parents combat the challenging event by facilitating their children beyond their capabilities to take on major parts of their formal education ensuring that they receive the necessary resources and assistance.

Participant 4 explained that,

"Makagahin ko ug oras sa pagpasabot nila pero kana ra pong mga lessons nga sayon ug makaya ra nakong matudlo. Magdepende ra ko kung unsa akong nahibal an nga lesson. Kung lisod na, mag search man ko." (I spare my time helping them understand the lesson but only those lessons that are within my own capabilities. It depends on the lesson I know. If it is complicated then I will be going to search about it.)

However, some parents can't spare their time due to time pressure. They are hesitant to take part in guiding the child to learn because they don't have extra time in assessing the child to learn and answer the module right away without a proper explanation.

Parent 2 stated that,

"Wala na jud koy oras para motudlo nila maong dretosohon nalang naku ug answer." (I don't have

time to teach so to make it easier I'll just go straight and answer.)

As Modular Learning has emerged, parents provide the luxury of time and sometimes seek help when they are not familiar with the topic. They wanted the best for their children, the participant lend time in the evening to help and improve their comprehension and reading skills. A child's nature to possess lively energy and get what they want so parent always has some punishment for them to be disciplined.

Participant 10 explained that,

"Naa jud time, kay katong High School nga maoy motabang sa grade 4 usahay lisuran unya magpatabang sad nako. Ug naay timpong ting klase, magabii tudloan rag basa. Mabunalan jud kay dili kasabot. Unya laki baya akoo dugay kasabot." (Yes, when I am needed, I find time and during the night time I teach my child to read. But sometimes I punished him for being hard headed.)

The Naturalist theme emphasized that it is imperative that in the sudden shift of the educational system it is parents' phenomenal role to guide and provide their children time in the teaching-learning process. However, some instances are not easy as it seems. Most of them encounter challenges in the midst of assisting their child but they cope with this phenomenon brought by the new mode of learning and fill in the learning gaps of their child because is their natural tendency to provide time to assess their children's learning.

The Realist

Modular distance learning is helpful in some aspects. Though parents find it convenient for their children to learn at home, learning in the presence of a teacher and classroom is different. They tell the truth that even with its benefits, it is essential for their children to be in a better education system. Face-to-face learning gives room for growth and development. The interaction between teacher and learners is precise and straightforward enabling them to easily communicate with one another and learners can ask the teacher direct questions whenever they have problems.

As Participant 1 said:

"Kung no choice mo agree nalang tungod sa atong panahon karon. About sa iyang learning naa man pero lahi ra gyud kung sa f2f kay daghan silang makat-

onan sa skwelahan.” (If I don’t have a choice, you only agree because of our situation. About his learning, yes there’s learning but it’s very different when it comes to f2f because they learn a lot in school.)

Participant 1 did not deny the fact that they are only obliged to agree to this learning modality due to the pandemic. Participant 1 said that there is a difference in what their child learned during face-to-face classes and in this modular learning. With face-to-face learning, teachers can better facilitate and assess their students’ understanding as well as they are most effectively held accountable for every student’s learning.

Similarly, Parent 4 stated that:

“Dili, mas ganahan ko nga face-to-face. Kay para nako walay nakat-onan akong mga anak ani nga module. Kay sa tinuod lang kay murag nagsalig nalang nako ang akong anak kay naa may magtudlo niya, unya wala siya kasabot. Mas nindot na ang maestra jud ang magtudlo ba kay naay uban kay dili man nako masabtan tapos maglisod kog explain niya ba.” (No, I prefer to have face-to-face classes because for me, my children didn’t learn in this modular set-up. To be honest, my child is now only depending on me because she has someone who can teach her even though she didn’t understand. It is better to be taught by a teacher since there are some things I can’t understand and can hardly explain to her.)

Parents are the facilitators and guides to their children but, for various reasons, they are the ones who ended up doing the modules instead. Children may feel more gratified knowing that they always have someone who can do the task for them. However, too much dependence could only impose a downward effect on their development. With parents also having a hard time teaching the modules, we can say that there’s little to no improvement in children’s learning if there is no presence of a teacher.

The transition from traditional learning to face-to-face modality caused by the pandemic is a sign for all school administrators, teachers, students, and parents. The study of Shallimar Bayucca (2021) shows three (3) struggles of parents during this new modality of learning. One of the struggles presented in the study was the difficulty of the children in concentrating on their studies.

Participant 6 agrees with that as she says,

“Dili, kay kung kami ang mutudlo dili mopatoo ang bata lahi rajod kong maestra ang mutudlo.” (No, because the child won’t listen to us compared to teachers.)

Participant 6 knows the limitations of her superiority over his child. There are times that they will prevail as what the parents obliged them to do but some of those may be hard for them to follow. In-home learning, children tend to lose concentration in answering the module for they have many responsibilities wherein in the school, the only responsibility led to them was to become a student. Parents lost control of their children and this becomes a reason why they want teachers to educate their children. They see teachers fitted in facilitating education to their children not themselves as a result of the behavior being conducted by the learners towards them. There are also factors contributing to the trust of parents in the teacher for aiding their children. Parents’ difficulty in catering reference learning materials, examples in elaborating the lesson, difficulty in understanding the topic, and the time allotment was also affecting the confidence of the parents in delivering education to learners.

As participant 8 pointed out,

“Di gyud kay lahi ra gyud ang face to face nga pagtudlo kaysa aning module-module lang.” (No because face to face teaching is really different compared to modular learning.)

Participant 8 stated the difference between the two modalities. Where in face-to-face learning, there is an assurance that children can learn in every lesson thoroughly while modular learning is unmeasurable for evaluation is not precise. Various circumstances varied the two modalities where parents know and pursue that face-to-face learning is more convenient.

In everyday lives, parents are preoccupied with tasks and they said that it would be better if the teacher will mold the minds of their children so they can learn better.

Participant 10 answered,

“Dili oy kapoy kaayo, maypa tong maestro.” (No, it’s tiring. It’s the teacher’s part.)

Participant 10 mentioned that it is tiring on their part. They find tiring to assist their children at home with their modules and depend on the teacher because they believe that it’s their job to provide academic growth and development.

The Realist theme emphasized the existence of an objective reality of modular learning modality. Parents know their abilities and limitations in this learning setup. They speak truthfully and understand their important role in educating their children. They acknowledge the importance of teachers in molding and facilitating the learning of the various learner. This theme is designed to apprehend the parent's perspective if they can cater to their child's learning in this new setup brought to countermeasure the unable traditional modality.

The Level of Experience

Many parents are experiencing difficulty in teaching modules to their children. Parents are also confused and how to do it because they do not know how to answer and now, they are assigned or obligated to help their children. The response highlights the struggles that

the data shows many families are experiencing.

Parent 1 said that,

"Pinakalisod nga na encounter is kanang mag-answer kas iyang module nga maglisod kag asa ka mangutana kay hasta ka wala makasabot Least: okay ra ang math ug english ma kaya2 ra gyud." (The hardest thing that I have encountered is answering my child's modular Activity, for I do not know to whom I should ask if there are things I cannot understand. Math and English subject I can manage to answer.)

In addition to their typical responsibilities of job and family, parents have now been assigned the duty of the main teacher, which has generated additional difficulties for most parents. The researchers found that parents will still struggle and can't manage time because it's not part of their priorities.

Parent 2 said that,

"Ang pagsabot sa module ug paggahin sa oras sa mga buluhaton sa balay ug sa module. Masugo sugo rah nako akong mga anak." (Understanding the module and spending time on homework of my child and I will also ask my children to do the household chores.)

Parent 3 stated that,

"Halos man tanan tanan pud. Kay ang mga gipangtudlo ron lahi rapud sauna ug karon. Mas lisod² ron nga module. Mas nindot tong face to face jud. -

Kasagaran mga Filipino subjects ug kanang mga sayon sayon ra. Naa may usahay nga walay kuan answer key. Diha jud toy bulan nga way answer key, kami rajuy gaanswer nga mama. Ang kinalisuran ug naay answer key, ako, dayun way answer key adto jud magpatabang jud kos akong manghod. Mao nang nindot jud ang face to face kay ngano ug ing.ana modular ra wa juy makat.unang mga bata. Labi na parte sa math. Grabe ang math sa Grade 4 ron." (Almost everything. Their lessons are far different from before. Today it's much more difficult, which is why I would prefer face to face learning. Mostly Filipino subject and some other subjects are manageable, but there are times when that there's no answer key written on the Modules that's probably the most difficult part. There's a month when there was no answer key in the modular Activity, so all of us mothers will have to answer every question on our own not knowing if it's right or wrong, that's why I have to ask for help from my younger sibling. This is why I prefer face to face learning because through modular activity children can't learn anything. Most especially in Math, Grade 4 math is way too difficult.)

The learning timeline and foundation before and today are indeed very different. With this factor, parents in elementary grades under modular learning were greatly challenged not just in matters like teaching their children with their limited knowledge but with the drawback, this modality has impacted when it comes to the education of their young ones. As mathematics is one of the parent's greatest challenges in making their children understand its concepts when they even weren't knowledgeable enough in the first place.

Parent 7 said that,

"Tudluan nakog math, (naay nakat-unan?) Oo - English jud di ko ka kuan, math ing ana mga mtb sayun ra." (I teach my children math and yes, they learn something from it. English was the hardest for me to teach. Math and MTB are easy.)

Researchers found that some parents are not a jack of all trades. It only means that they cannot give proper education to their child due to the limited knowledge they have.

Parent 9 further added that,

"Bisan Elementary pa sila noh, lisod jud kaau jud samot na akong grade 4 dli jud madala nko, nya wala

mi ana sa una, unsa ragud to amo sauna, wala mi kasugat in ana jud. Hala pagkalisura jd magpatabang jud silingan. Kani rajung akoang, kaning akong gamay grade 1 in ana maoy sayon sayon, kai ang grade 1 gd is MTB pamn ilaha dali rajud kaayo sa tanan sabton.” (Although they are still in Elementary, the lessons are difficult and I can’t manage it. Also, we haven’t encountered the lessons before. That is why we ask help from our neighbor. My grade 1 child is the least challenging because they are using MTB and it is easy to understand for me.)

One of the highlights of parents lived experiences in a Modular setup is the fact that their prior knowledge about any subject is unrelatable to the current knowledge in the lessons being talked about in the modules of their children. The fact that they weren’t able to encounter the same things made the situation of the parents worse and more difficult. And only those that are quite familiar with the MTB subject lighten the burden.

This theme The Level of Experience emphasized that the parents lived experiences can be summarized into two integral key points: challenging and limited knowledge. However, it was beyond applaudable how the parents strongly embrace and firmly overcome the challenges brought by their children’s Modular Distance Learning having limited knowledge due to the obsolete learning foundation of parents, becomes more of a stepping stone to teach their children better rather than being a miserable case then making the situation worse.

The Light

As stated by Paco et.al (2021), parents found it not easy and challenging for them to carry out their duties and obligations to assist children at home. The transition of learning brings another challenge and adds more responsibilities to the parents however, researchers try to discover if parents do also find light amidst this new learning modality set-up.

Parent 1 said that,

“Naa in terms sa ilang safety maka assure gyud ka isip usa ka ginikanan nga safe sila.”. (Yes, in terms of their safety you can really assure as a parent that they are safe.)

Parents think for the health and safety of their children. They are embracing the good side of this new modality and recognize it for assuring them that their children

are way protected when they are at home.

Parent 2 also said that,

“Naa kay makagahin kog dakong oras para sa akong mga anak.” (Yes, because I can spend a lot of time with my children.)

This new modality offers more quality time for their children and family. It is what is something that at least can bring comfort to parents. In this way, they are grateful enough that they could spend more time with their children and do some reflection to appreciate one another's presence.

Parent 3 mentioned that,

“Naa. Ang nindot nga mahatag kay ang pamatasan. Makagahin kog oras nila sa pagtudlo ug pamatasan sa isig ka tawo.” (There is. The best thing that I could give to them is to teach my son's/daughter's how to be respectful. I can spare time to teach them how to respect others.)

Aside from that, they can have family time for the children, and the parents would like to have value integration with their children. This parent would love to teach good manners while they are also learning their lessons. It is the best thing that they could at least teach them the values while they are at home, to make use of the time meaningfully.

Parent 4 stated that,

“Ang positive nga impact para sa akua kay naa ra siya diri sa balay, kanang maka save mi sa ilang plete ug allowance. Mao ra jud na ang positive para nako. Pero in terms sa learning or leksyon kay wala jud. Hinuon naa jud pud koy time maka bonding niya ug maka assist sad siya nako ba, ilabi na nga nagtinda tinda mi, masugo ra siya nako kay naa siya diri sa balay.” (The positive impact for me is that they are just staying at home, we can save money for the transportation fee and allowance. That is the only positive thing for me. But in terms of learning, there is none. Somehow, I could spend time bonding with her, and especially she can help me assist in our little store. I can ask her in doing the household chores.

Being able to save money is one of the advantages of this new mode of learning. They can budget the money for the most important matters. But, this kind of set-up contributes nothing to the learning of their children. And yet, parents take advantage of the presence of

their children at home to request assistance in doing the household chores which is like a win-win situation between the parents and children.

Parent 5 mentioned that,

“Ma assessan ang mga anak nku ari ras balay pero mas ok jud tong adto sa skuylahan mura man jud silay ma kuan ilang huna- huna mafocus gani sila pagtudlo.” (The children can be assessed when they are at home, but it is better for them to go to school, because when they are at school their minds are focus in studying.)

The parents can help, assist and guide their children at home but they are more likely to send their children to school if they were to choose. They prefer a quality learning from their children which can beget at school than at home and just being taught by their, parents who were not knowledgeable enough to answer modules. They want to focus their children on studying at school than helping their parents at home, however, their health is the most important one.

Parent 6 mentioned that,

“Nagpasalamat pod ko kay nakat on sad ko. Mura pod kog niskwelag balik nga ang wa namo nahibaw e sauna nahibaw an na namo karon”. (I'm thankful because I also learn. It is somewhat I become a student again. I have learned new lessons that I haven't encountered before.)

Parents are thankful and somehow amazed by this new modality since they are also learning new concepts. They feel like they are attending school again because they learn lessons that they haven't encountered before. This brings back the forgotten knowledge and also relives the experiences they had had before. Parents do compare their lessons before to this new era and they amazingly admitted that it is difficult for them to handle difficult subjects. But because of this new mode of learning, they are learning too with their children, which is a good thing for them.

Parent 9 mentioned that,

“Oh naa, naa pd oy, oh naa rajd unta. Pero para nko jd sa kung akoi pabut on lang jd d pd jud ko mooyon in ani kai ngano masugo lagi nimo pero wa man say makuan ang bata gd, kung ako lang juy pabut on, pwde jd kai kung naa lang juy face to face, face to face rajud kai mas dako ang chance nga ang bata makabalo jud ddto.” (Yes, there is but if I were to

decide I would not agree with this modular set-up because as a parent, I find face to face classes way better for them.)

Parents believed that there is still a positive impact to the new learning set-up but they preferred to have face-to-face classes. They believed that face-to-face classes are more suitable for learning, enhancing, and developing their children. They are not convinced that their children are learning.

Parent 10 stated that,

“Ah wala oy.” (No. Nothing at all.)

This statement is very strong and brave on the parent's part. The parent doesn't see any positive impact on this modular learning and this is saddening to learn the parent's perspective.

This theme, The Light, unravels on what is the parents' perspective on modular learning if do they find a positive impact of modular learning to them as a parent. From the aforementioned quotes of the parents, most parents tend to see the bright side of these trying times.

Conclusion and Recommendation

Modular Distance Learning has become a viable alternative to traditional schools, such instances allow parents to experience different challenges. This new method of learning was unusual for parents and caused extensive disruption of routines in their daily lives. Yet, the emerging phenomenon is inescapable where THE CAPABLE has the capacity and never stop striving to create new ways for their children to learn. THE NATURALIST highlights the pivotal role of parents where most of them never hesitate to guide and provide time for their children even if things are not easy as it appears as the educational system undergoes rapid changes. THE REALIST speaks the truth that engaging in the new setup of learning is challenging and finds traditional learning effective. THE LEVEL OF EXPERIENCE becomes a turning point to better teach the children where parents are admirable for conquering the difficulties. THE LIGHT delves into what parents think about modular learning and most parents strive to see the bright side of these tough times. It is recommended to hear them out, maintain open lines of contact with teachers regarding the children's circumstances so that teachers can accommodate the obstacles that parents face on a daily basis, and provide opportunities for improving parent's

quality mentoring in facilitating the children. It should be pushed to become at the vanguard of this transformational process of learning, give extension for deadlines and schools must at least implement a day to have Parent Seminars and Training on the topics presented in weekly modules so as parents can teach their children effectively at home.

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Table 1. *The Analysis*

Horizons	Textural Language	Themes
Makaya ra nako siyang tudloan kung pananglit lisuran siya·kaya nako siyang suportaang ug dili na gyud niya makaya. Lisuda gyud itudlo ilabi na kay ang qkong mga nahibal-an sauna nangapapas na. (<i>I can only teach him if for example that my child was having difficulties with this and I'll do what I can do for my child. It's really hard to teach especially since my knowledge already faded.</i>) (P1) Dili, Kay ang module karon gud kay lahi na, lisod kanang nakaskwela ko pero ang mga topic karon bisan sa grade 3 kay ni level up na. lisod siya hubaron. (<i>No because the lessons are very difficult and different from what I have encountered way back in our time.</i>) (P6) Puydi raguud ug mahimo unya ug malisud najud akong anak mao ng mutabang najud ko niya pero ug sayun sayun ra siya ra kay maanad unya. (<i>I can if possible but if my child finds it difficult, I would help. If the lesson is easy, I would let my child to answer alone so that they will become independent.</i>) (P8) Oh, kaya nalang jd, kayahon nlang bsan kai mao may kuan kung naa palang laing choice. (<i>Yes, I have to since I don't have any choice left but to try.</i>) (P9)	Scaffolding within a limited capacity Obsolete Learning Foundation Independent Learning Reinforcement Imperative Parental Involvement	The Capable
Oo makagahin pero dili gyud full time kay naa pud koy baby pud gud. (<i>Yes, I can spend but not full time because I have a baby.</i>) (P1) Wala na jud koy oras para motudlo nila maong dretosohon nalang naku ug answer. (<i>I don't have time to teach so to make it easier I'll just go straight and answer.</i>) (P2) Makagahin ko ug oras sa pagpasabot nila pero kana ra pong mga lessons nga sayon ug makaya ra nakong matudlo. Magdepende ra ko kung unsa akong nahibal an nga lesson. Kung lisod na, mag search man ko. (<i>I spare my time helping them understand the lesson but only those lessons that are within my own capabilities. It depends on the lesson I know. If it is complicated then I will be going to</i>	Divided Responsibilities Direct Response due to Time Pressure Limited Capabilities Time Allotment	The Naturalist

search about it.) (P4)

Ouh, makahatag jud kay ing ana man jud na.
(*Yes, I can give time because that's how it is*)
(P5)

Direct Attention

Oh, naa jud kay kuan man di man gud
mahimo ug di tudluan. (*Yes, because I need
to teach my child in order to learn.*) (P8)

Conflict in Parental
Duties

Naa jud time, kay katong High School nga
maoy motabang sa grade 4 usahay lisuran
unya magpatabang sad nako. Ug naay
timpong tingklase, magabii tudloan rag basa.
Mabunalan jd kai d kasabot. Nya laki baya
akoa dugay kasabot. (*Yes, when I am needed,
I find time, and during night time I teach my
child to read. But sometimes I punished him
for being hard-headed.*) (P10)

Kung no choice mo agree nalang tungod sa
atong panahon karon. About sa iyang
learning naa man pero lahi ra gyud kung sa
f2f kay daghan silang makat-onan sa
skwelahan. (*If I don't have a choice, you
only agree because of our situation. About
his learning, yes there's learning but it's very
different when it comes to f2f because they
learn a lot in school.*) (P1)

No Choice at All

The Realist

Dili, mas ganahan ko nga face-to-face. Kay
para nako walay nakat-onan akong mga anak
ani nga module. Kay sa tinuod lang kay
murag nagsalig nalang nako ang akong anak
kay naa may magtudlo niya, unya wala siya
kasabot. Mas nindot na ang maetra jud ang
magtudlo ba kay naay uban kay dili man
nako masabtan tapos maglisod kog explain
niya ba. (*No, I prefer to have face-to-face
classes because for me, my children didn't
learn in this modular set-up. To be honest,
my child is now only depending on me
because she has someone who can teach her
even though she didn't understand. It is
better to be taught by a teacher since there
are some things I can't understand and can
hardly explain to her.*) (P4)

Teacher's Dependence

Teacher's Dependence

Dili, kay kung kami ang mutudlo dili
mopatoo ang bata lahi rajod kong maestra
ang mutudlo. (*No, because the child won't
listen to us compared to teachers.*) (P6)

Preference for Learning

Modality

Di gyud kay lahi ra gyud ang face to face nga pagtudlo kaysa aning module-module lang. *(No because face to face teaching is really different compared to modular learning.)* (P8)

Teacher's Dependence

Dili oy kapoy kaayo, maypa tong maestro. *(No, it's tiring. It's the teacher's part.)* (P10)

Pinakalisod nga na encounter is kanang mag-answer kas iyang module nga maglisod kag asa ka mangutana kay hasta ka wala makasabot Least: okay ra ang math ug english ma kaya2 ra gyud. *(The hardest thing that I have encountered is answering my child's modular Activity, for I do not know to whom I should ask if there are things I cannot understand. Math and English subject I can manage to answer.)* (P1)

Complexity and Confusion

The Level of Experience

Ang pagsabot sa module ug paggahin sa oras sa mga buluhaton sa balay ug sa module. Masugo sugo rah nako akong mga anak. *(Understanding the module and spending time on homework of my child and I will also ask my children to do the household chores.)* (P2)

Allocation of time

Halos man tanan tanan pud. Kay ang mga gipangtudlo ron lahi rapud sauna ug karon. Mas lisod² ron nga module. Mas nindot tong face to face jud. - Kasagaran mga Filipino subjects ug kanang mga sayon sayon ra. Naa may usahay nga walay kuan answer key. Diha jud toy bulan nga way answer key, kami rajuy gaanswer nga mama. Ang kinalisuran ug naay answer key, ako, dayun way answer key adto jud magpatabang jud kos akong manghod. Mao nang nindot jud ang face to face kay ngano ug ing.ana modular ra wa juy makat.unang mga bata. Labi na parte sa math. Grabe ang math sa Grade 4 ron. *(Almost everything. Their lessons are far different from before. Today it's much more difficult, which is why I would prefer face to face learning. Mostly Filipino subject and some other subjects are manageable, but there are times when that there's no answer key written on the Modules that's probably the most difficult part.)*

Obsolete Learning Foundation

There's a month when there was no answer key in the modular Activity, so all of us mothers will have to answer every question on our own not knowing if it's right or wrong, that's why I have to ask for help from my younger sibling. This is why I prefer face to face learning because through modular activity children can't learn anything. Most especially in Math, Grade 4 math is way too difficult.) (P3)

Selection of subject matter

Tudluan nakog math, (naay nakat-unan?) Oo - English jud di ko ka kuan, math ing ana mga mtb sayun ra. *(I teach my child math and yes, they learn something from it. English was the hardest for me to teach. Math and MTB are easy.)* (P7)

Obsolete Learning Foundation

Bisan Elementary pa sila noh, lisod jud kaau jud samot na akong grade 4 dli jud madala nko, nya wala mi ana sa una, unsa ragud to amo sauna, wala mi kasugat in ana jud. Hala pagkalisura jd magpatabang jud silingan. Kani rajung akoang, kaning akong gamay grade 1 in ana maoy sayon sayon, kai ang grade 1 gd is MTB pamn ilaha dali rajud kaayo sa tanan sabton. *(Although they are still in Elementary, the lessons are difficult and I can't manage it. Also, we haven't encountered the lessons before. That is why we ask help from our neighbor. My grade 1 child is the least challenging because they are using MTB and it is easy to understand for me.)* (P9)

Naa in terms sa ilang safety maka assure gyud ka isip usa ka ginikanan nga safe sila. *(Yes, in terms of their safety you can really assure as a parent that they are safe.)* (P1)

Health conscious

The Light

Naa kay makagahin kog dakong oras para sa akong mga anak. *(Yes, because I can spend a lot of time with my children.)* (P2)

Quality time

Naa. Ang nindot nga mahatag kay ang pamatasan. Makagahin kog oras nila sa pagtudlo ug pamatasan sa isig ka tawo. *(There is. The best thing that I could give to them is to teach my son's/daughter's how to be respectful. I can spare time to teach them how to respect others.)* (P3)

Values Integration

Financial Literacy

Ang positive nga impact para sa akua kay naa ra siya diri sa balay, kanang maka save mi sa ilang plete ug allowance. Mao ra jud na ang positive para nako. Pero in terms sa learning or leksyon kay wala jud. Hinuon naa jud pud koy time maka bonding niya ug maka assist sad siya nako ba, ilabi na nga nagtinda tinda mi, masugo ra siya nako kay naa siya diri sa balay. *(The positive impact for me is that they are just staying at home, we can save money for the transportation fee and allowance. That is the only positive thing for me. But in terms of learning, there is none. Somehow, I could spend time bonding with her and especially she can help me assist in our little store. I can ask her in doing the household chores.)* (P4)

Educational priority

Ma assessan ang mga anak nku ari ras balay pero mas ok jud tong adto sa skuylahan mura man jud silay ma kuan ilang huna- huna mafocus gani sila pagtudlo. *(The children can be assessed when they are at home, but it is better for them to go to school, because when they are at school their minds are focus in studying.)* (P5)

Recalled knowledge

Nagpasalamat pod ko kay nakat on sad ko. Mura pod kog niskwelag balik nga ang wa namo nahibaw e sauna nahibaw an na namo karon. *(I'm thankful because I also learn. It is somewhat I become a student again. I have learned new lessons that I haven't encountered before.)* (P6)

Practicality

Oh naa, naa pd oy, oh naa rajd unta. Pero para nko jd sa kung akoi pabut on lang jd d pd jud ko mooyon in ani kai ngano masuko lagi nimo pero wa man say makuan ang bata gd, kung ako lang juy pabut on, pwde jd kai kung naa lang juy face to face, face to face rajud kai mas dako ang chance nga ang bata makabalo jud ddto. *(Yes, there is but if I were to decide I would not agree with this modular set-up because as a parent, I find face to face classes way better for them.)* (P9)

Discontentment on learning modality

Ah wala oy. *(No. Nothing at all.)* (P10)